and Kalkat was taken before Nehru on 24 October 1947, to relate his account.[10] Nehru was reportedly livid at Baldev Singh, Thapar and Kulwant Singh, but it was now too late. In later years, Kalkat wrote a book called *The Far-flung Frontiers*, detailing his experiences. Field Marshal Manekshaw, then a Brigadier in the military operations directorate, wrote the foreword to this book and never contradicted Kalkat's arguments. Manekshaw also wrote a foreword to Maj. Gen. Bajwa's book *The First Kashmir War 1947–48*, and again confirmed this thesis.[11]

Hari Singh Under Pressure

The slow erosion of the Maharaja's control over his own territories was now on in full swing. It was clear that Maj. Brown and the Gilgit Scouts were the real power in the Gilgit Agency. Notwithstanding the termination of the lease and the installation of Governor Ghansara Singh, the Maharaja's writ was a rapidly fading flame. The situation in Poonch was no different. During the course of September 1947, the Poonch uprising acquired a formal command structure. Sardar Mohammed Ibrahim Khan had escaped from Srinagar at the end of August and made his way to Pakistan. There he managed to set up a base at the hill station of Murree, only 33 km from Poonch, where he became the initiator and controller of an unofficial command post. Weapons were collected, many of them ancient muzzle-loaders, ammunition was prepared and supplies were smuggled across the Jhelum into Poonch and Mirpur, where he had fathered a military organisation of demobilised Poonch soldiers. Soon, a number of Muslim officers in the Jammu and Kashmir state army deserted the Maharaja and joined this force. They were soon followed by volunteers from Pakistan including several former Muslim INA officers who were looking for action. The most famous of these was Maj. Zaman Kiani a former trusted assistant of Netaji.[12] He was, more or less, the main Military Commander under Sardar Muhammad Ibrahim Khan. The funds for this organisation were provided by Mian Iftikharuddin, a wealthy Muslim League politician from